A rich main meal soup naturally thickened with okra—a classic gumbo ingredient. In its native Louisiana, sweet ground sassafras leaves would be used.

mixed seafood gumbo

SERVES 6 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 50 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 2 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 2

1 tbsp sunflower oil
1 onion, chopped
2 celery ribs, chopped
1 large garlic clove, chopped
4oz (115g) chorizo, sliced
2 tbsp plain flour
2½ cups fish or chicken stock
1 x 14oz (400g) can chopped tomatoes
1 green bell pepper, diced
9oz (250g) okra, trimmed and cut into short lengths
¼ tsp cayenne pepper
½ tsp dried oregano
½ tsp sugar
salt and freshly ground black pepper
7oz (200g) mixed raw seafood
8oz (225g) long-grain rice
chopped parsley, to serve

1 Heat the oil in a large saucepan. Add the onion and celery and cook gently, stirring, for about 5 minutes, or until lightly golden. Stir in the garlic and chorizo and cook for 2 minutes. Stir in the flour and cook for another minute. Remove from the heat and gradually blend in the stock, then the tomatoes. Return to the heat and bring to a boil, stirring. Add the remaining ingredients, except the seafood and rice, bring back to a boil, reduce the heat, partially cover, and simmer gently for 30 minutes.

2 Add the seafood and simmer for another 5 minutes, stirring from time to time. Taste and season again to taste.

3 Meanwhile, cook the rice in plenty of boiling, lightly salted water for 10 minutes or until just tender (or as the package directs). Drain in a colander, rinse with boiling water, and drain again.

4 Spoon some rice into each of 6 large soup bowls. Ladle the gumbo over the top, sprinkle with a little chopped parsley, and serve hot.